

# Adding Rates

Add and edit production rates to estimate surfaces including custom rates, dimensions, products, and advanced pricing options.

Production rates in PaintScout define how long specific surfaces take to paint and automatically calculate pricing based on dimensions. After adding an area, you apply rates to each surface within it.

## How do you add rates to an estimate?

1. After setting up an area, pick a rate from the surface categories list. Select a category defined in your settings or create a custom rate.

Select Rate

Q Search surface categories

+ Custom Rate

Surface Category

|                  |                |
|------------------|----------------|
| Walls            | Ceilings       |
| Interior Trim    | Interior Doors |
| Interior Windows | Cabinets       |
| Prep             | Window Trim    |
| Closets          | Cabinets       |
| Flooring         |                |

Back

2. Choose an individual surface/rate. Again you can choose from the pre-made rates from your settings, or create a custom rate.

Select Rate

×

+ Custom Rate

Rate

1 Story Walls  
100 sqft/hr

2 Story Walls  
60 sqft/hr

Surface Category

Walls

Back

3. Once you've made your surface selection, it gets added to the area. From there, you can either edit that surface or continue adding more.

| <div>Master Bedroom</div> <div>Walls</div> <div>Width: 20ft Length: 18ft Height: 8ft</div> <div>Edit</div> |     |           |               |            |                | Area Price | \$406.25   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                            |     |           |               |            |                | Area Hours | 6.25       |
| Estimate ⓘ                                                                                                 |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| Description                                                                                                | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total (\$) |
| Walls<br>1 Story Walls - 608sqft                                                                           |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25 ... |
| + Add Surface                                                                                              |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| TOTAL                                                                                                      |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25     |

## How to edit a surface

1. Click directly on the surface or select the three dots to the right:

Master Bedroom  
Walls  
Width: 20ft Length: 18ft Height: 8ft

Edit

Area Price \$406.25  
Area Hours 6.25

Estimate

| Description             | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total (\$) |
|-------------------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|------------|
| Walls                   |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25     |
| 1 Story Walls - 608sqft |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| + Add Surface           |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| TOTAL                   |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25     |

Edit

Add More

Make Option

Archive

Copy

Delete

Save to settings

Options

| Description   | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total |
|---------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|-------|
| + Add Surface |     |           |               |            |                |            |       |

Add Media
Add Notes

Cancel
Add Area

2. Modify labels, edit rates, adjust dimensions, switch products, and access advanced options as needed.

- You can also fine-tune prep hours, painting hours, coats, and pricing.

**!** Editing a rate within an estimate only alters that particular rate and won't impact the preset rates stored in the Account Settings.

For instance, if you modify the rate for baseboards from 25lnft/hr to 15lnft/hr while creating an estimate, this change will solely apply to that specific rate within that particular area.

Edit Surface

Change Selection

Rate

Internal Label

1 Story Walls

Client Label

Walls

Length (FT)

18

Width (FT)

20

Height (FT)

8

switch to sqft ↺

Rate (sqft/hr)

100

Coats

2

Prep (hr)

Painting (hr)

6.25

Calculated Price (\$)

406.25

Show Formula

Product

+ Add Product

Notes

Area View Description ⓘ

Hours/Cost

Materials

Notes

Advanced

Back

Confirm

## Creating Custom Rates

1. When adding a surface to the area, select **+Custom Rate**.

### Select Rate

×

+ Custom Rate

Surface Category

|                  |                |
|------------------|----------------|
| Walls            | Ceilings       |
| Interior Trim    | Interior Doors |
| Interior Windows | Cabinets       |
| Prep             | Window Trim    |
| Closets          | Cabinets       |
| Flooring         |                |

[Back](#)

2. You will then be able to create a rate from scratch and customize it.

### Edit Surface

Change Selection

**Rate**

Internal Label

Client Label

Variable 1   Variable 2

Length (FT)  Width (FT)  Height (FT)  [switch to sqft](#)

Rate (sqft/hr)  Coats  Prep (hr)  Painting (hr)

Calculated Price (\$)  ☐ Show Formula

**Product**

[+ Add Product](#)

☒ Hours/Cost ☐ Materials ☐ Notes ☐ Advanced

[Back](#) [<](#) [>](#) [Confirm](#)

## Saving a custom rate to your settings

When creating a custom rate, you can choose the option to save it to your settings. The rate then becomes available for future estimates.

**i** Saving a custom rate makes it reusable. Changes to the rate on the current estimate remain specific to that estimate.

1. Click the three dots next to the rate.
2. Select **Save to settings**.

The screenshot shows the 'Master Bedroom' estimate interface. At the top, it displays 'Walls, Crown Molding (1)' with an 'Edit' button. To the right, it shows 'Area Price \$471.25' and 'Area Hours 7.25'. Below this is the 'Estimate' section with a table of items:

| Description                      | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total (\$) |
|----------------------------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|------------|
| Walls<br>1 Story Walls - 608sqft |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25     |
| Crown Molding                    | 1   |           | 1             | 1          |                | 65.00      | 65.00      |
| + Add Surface                    |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| TOTAL                            |     |           | 7.25          | 7.25       |                | 471.25     | 471.25     |

Below the estimate table is the 'Options' section with another table:

| Description   | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total |
|---------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|-------|
| + Add Surface |     |           |               |            |                |            |       |

At the bottom of the interface are buttons for 'Add Media', 'Add Notes', 'Cancel', and 'Add Area'. A context menu is open on the right side of the 'TOTAL' row, showing options: Edit, Add More, Make Option, Archive, Copy, Delete, and **Save to settings**.

3. You will be prompted to select the **Rate Category** the rate will belong to. [Learn about Rate Categories.](#)

**Master Bedroom**  
Walls, Crown Molding (1) Edit  
Width: 20ft Length: 18ft Height: 8ft

Area Price \$471.25  
Area Hours 7.25

**Estimate**

| Description                      | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total (\$) |
|----------------------------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|------------|
| Walls<br>1 Story Walls - 608sqft |     |           | 6.25          | 6.25       |                | 406.25     | 406.25     |
| Crown Molding<br>1               | 1   |           | 1             | 1          |                | 65.00      | 65.00      |
| + Add Surface                    |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |
| TOTAL                            |     |           | 7.25          | 7.25       |                | 471.25     | 471.25     |

**Options**

| Description   | Qty | Prep (hr) | Painting (hr) | Total (hr) | Materials (\$) | Labor (\$) | Total (\$) |
|---------------|-----|-----------|---------------|------------|----------------|------------|------------|
| + Add Surface |     |           |               |            |                |            |            |

Add Media Add Notes

Cancel < > Done

Options ☒

4. This rate can be found in your **Account Settings > Production Rates > Rate Categories**. This rate can now be applied to future estimates.

**Settings**

< Back

Account Details

Leads

Events

Pipelines

Estimates

Invoices

**Production Rates**

Rate Categories

Area Names

**Edit Rate Category**

Label \* Interior Trim

Estimate Types Interior, Cabinets

Rates

|            |     |               |     |
|------------|-----|---------------|-----|
| Baseboards | ... | Crown Molding | ... |
|------------|-----|---------------|-----|

+ Add New Rate

Confirm

## Related articles

### **Adding Areas**

Add and customize areas (rooms or spaces) to estimates with dimensions, area types, surfaces, and automatic price calculations.

### **Area Names**

Create and organize reusable area labels like rooms and locations for faster estimate creation with drag-and-drop organization.